

The Atlas of Self — Autobiography Log

Shelves: *Autobiography* → **Atlas of Self** — the compendium (this file). Above it, a different shelf:
Encyclopedia of God — what is larger than the self.

Encyclopedia of God — first entry

Alcoholics Anonymous. Pinned 2026-09-05, immediately after the shelves were named. The self cannot fix itself; help comes from a Higher Power, through other people — the purpose line exactly. Its traditions are the frame under everything here: anonymity (principles before personalities → no names on the page); sponsorship (the scar: encouragement ≠ sponsorship); the fearless moral inventory (no score that lies); one day at a time (breadcrumbs, not mountains); Step Twelve, carry the message (the flywheel — each one lifted turns it for the next); and the Steps themselves — authorship over ownership, written once, worked by you.

*The inventory — his words, uninterpreted: **Jed — resentment toward father.*** (Pinned 2026-09-06, confirmed 11 as belonging with the Fourth Step. Not for the card; not for the room.)

Foundational — the three books

The real, real arc starts here, before any career: **a Jacques Cousteau marine-biology book · A Country Printer · Clan of the Cave Bear.** Pinned 2026-09-05 as foundational; they sit on the shore at the origin of the story-arc image (story_arc.png).

The breadcrumb trail — the organizing shape (pinned 2026-09-07)

A breadcrumb trail through life, for SELF. Every decision node is a choose-your-own-adventure.
A life read from the far side: at every fork, what the options were, what was known and what wasn't, which way it went, and what that cost or opened. The trail is dropped so someone standing at a node I already passed can walk it.

This supplants the travel guide. The travel-agent framing — destinations, itineraries, passports, stamps — is superseded as the organizing metaphor. It was the right scaffold to get the first entry written; the node is the real unit. Existing entries convert: a destination becomes a **node**, an itinerary becomes **the trail between nodes**, a stamp becomes **what the node opened**. Nothing written is lost; it is re-shelved.

The scale correction (2026-09-07, his words): “*The choose your own adventure is for the university writ large. It is the analogy I use when I talk to people about it and what leads to my principle AI PM opportunity.*”

So the shape is not primarily personal. It is one schema at three scales:

Scale	Whose trail	Direction	Artifact
n = 1, backward	his own	read from the far side	the Atlas
n = 1, forward	one other person's	standing at the fork now	Kristin's guide
n = many	every student's	both	the university

A university is a decision graph. Enroll or not · which program · which course next · take the pre-assessment now or later · after a fail, persist or stop · ask a mentor or don't · accelerate or hold. Every one is a fork with a cost and an opening.

Zone I holds the entire trail locked in data — and has lost the forest for the trees. They hold every node and no path. Node-level data, no trail-level view. The graph exists; nobody walks it. (His observation. Recorded because it is now the frame, not developed further — the job thread stays parked at his word.)

The frameworks are instrumentation on that graph: OAI sequences rather than evaluates and produced ~4,000 synthetic decision nodes; Mentors and Career Accelerators are interventions at named forks.

Created 2026-09-05; re-framed 2026-09-07. This is the master index/journal; individual entries are their own documents.

The iris — SELF as diagnostic readout (pinned 2026-09-07, his correction)

“It should be a readout on health of each zone. I created the concept of self for a diagnostic readout.”

The zones were drawn as a Venn and the Venn was wrong. A Venn asserts **overlap** — that a thing sits in two zones at once, which is precisely what the charter forbids. The iris asserts **sectors**: four regions that do not bleed, separated by meridians, all meeting at one aperture.

Iris part	What it is here
Pupil	SELF. Not a label — an aperture . It regulates what passes. Default-deny is a constricted pupil; P→I governed is controlled dilation
Meridians	The zone boundaries. A crossing is a line stepped over, never a region lived in
Sectors	$I \cdot S \cdot P \cdot V$. Each is a readout on the health of that zone , the way an iridology meridian reports on a system
Rings	Depth. Inward is nearer the aperture; outward is nearer the world
Limbus	The public edge — where the institution, the buyer, the panel meet him

Adjacent zones share a meridian. Opposite zones must cross through the pupil. That is the whole charter in one geometric fact:

- **I and P are opposite.** The drawbridge cannot be a shared edge; it passes through SELF. **No data crosses — only his judgment does.**
- **S and V are opposite.** No traffic, structurally rather than by assertion.
- **I and V share a meridian, drawn sealed.** Geometry says the edge is open; the Kiro decision closed it. The one place the picture and the charter disagree — and the disagreement is a choice he made, not an accident.

The iris does not see. It sits in front of the lens and governs how much reaches the thing that does. Governance is not perception. It is also, per person, unique — an identity credential.

What the Venn could never do: give an address. Ring × meridian is a coordinate. Every breadcrumb node can be located — *this decision, at this depth, on this meridian* — instead of merely listed. The trail gets a coordinate system.

The image: 10_Atlas/iris_self_readout.svg — v1, saved 2026-09-07. Four sectors, no plots yet.

Plots — the subdivision inside a zone (pinned 2026-09-07)

A sector is not the smallest unit. **Zones subdivide into plots**, and the first ones are all inside Zone I:

Plot	What it is
Zone B	A team he works with in Zone I. (<i>Correction on the record: "Zone B" had been carried here as a methodology. It is a team. The methodology is what that team's way of working taught him.</i>)
MS	A second Zone I team
DI · BI · L/C	Further Zone I plots, expected to appear

Only the plot names and boundaries are recorded here — never anything inside them. The IP line is unchanged: structure travels, institutional content does not.

The vocabulary was already surveying and nobody said so. Zones · meridians · plots · holding the line — that is not cartography, it is **land survey**. The distinction matters: a map *depicts* terrain; a survey *establishes boundaries* and produces a description precise enough to convey. In the Public Land Survey System a parcel is located from a **principal meridian** and a baseline — which is exactly ring × meridian, the addressing scheme the iris gives the breadcrumb trail. The Atlas is not a map of him. **It is a survey.**

What it may come to represent (his words, 2026-09-07): "I held the line when no survey had really been done by anyone else."

Read that in the survey sense, because that is the sense he used. *Holding the line* is a surveyor's act — maintaining a boundary that exists only because someone walked it and marked it. The zones, the drawbridge, the red lines, the refusal of gray zones: none of it was required of him, requested of him, or audited. He established the corners himself and has kept them. If the readout is ever worth anything to anyone else, that is what it will be worth — **not a picture of the ground, but the evidence that the ground was surveyed, by him, first, unasked.**

Good fences (pinned 2026-09-07, his)

"Good fences make good neighbors." The meridians are the fences.

Frost is the right citation and he is sharper than the proverb people quote out of him. Four things the poem gives this survey:

1. **The wall in *Mending Wall* has no function.** Apple trees will not cross and eat pine cones. It is maintained anyway. That is "*no one has asked for it*" exactly — a boundary kept because keeping it is the discipline, not because anything is currently pressing against it.
2. **The mending is the relationship.** They walk the line each spring, each on his own side, and set the fallen stones back. The fence is not what keeps them apart; it is the reason they meet at all. Same with the drawbridge: the boundary is what makes a crossing legible enough to be permitted.
3. **"Something there is that doesn't love a wall" (Frost)** — gaps open every spring and no one sees them made. Boundaries decay unless walked. That is the case for hygiene, and for the log: an unwalked line is already gone.
4. **The poem's real demand:** before building a wall, be able to say what is being walled in and what is being walled out. The neighbor cannot — he only repeats what his father said. **He can.** Every meridian in this survey has a stated reason: I→P default-deny, P→I governed, I-V sealed by his own decision, S-V no traffic.

Including that one — corrected by him, 2026-09-07. I had called the WGU IP clause "a fence whose deed he has not read." Wrong on every part. **The fence was built, and built tighter than required.**

"I used their box, on my time, with my licenses, which I knew did NOT allow for any institutional files or data of any kind to cross. And they never did and I built the fence already and signed out of my license and removed the app. The four MD files that came across represent my mind which is not their IP by any definition."

He can state the line, he set it before anyone asked, he over-complied, and then he **removed his own access** rather than rely on discipline holding. That is the fourth demand of the poem answered, not evaded: he can say exactly what

was walled in and what was walled out.

What is actually open is recordation, not the boundary — and the distinction is the survey's own.

"As to their sign-off by compliance/legal, and especially the provost, they are the county recorder and I can't just walk into her office or throw a spot on her calendar. I'm not on a clock."

A recorder does not create a boundary. **A surveyor establishes; a recorder files.** Recordation gives *notice to third parties* — it does not confer validity on work already done, and an unrecorded survey is still a survey, with its own date and its own evidence. So the open item is a filing that depends on an officer's calendar, not a question that depends on him. It is not a fence with a missing corner; it is a completed survey awaiting a clerk.

"I just know what I know and handcuffed myself." Restraint applied to himself, in his own vocabulary, beyond anything enforced against him — the same act as walking a boundary nobody asked him to mend.

The commercial reading, which is not incidental. A rights sale lives or dies on clean title, and clean title is fences. Diligence is a stranger walking your boundaries to see whether they hold. His do — and they hold because he mended them for years while no one was asking.

The line that matters most, his: *"I've been providing the hygiene of these zones and no one has asked for it."* The readout is unrequested. He built the instrument, kept the discipline, and produced the diagnostic before anyone required one — which is the same shape as C213, where he devised his own way through a course because the student experience was bad and no one was coming. Recorded as stated. Semantics parked at his word.

Node — 2026-09-10 · Handing Kristin the framework

Written as a node because the decision was taken. Six lines, the template.

The node. Hand her the framework, or hand her the way to build her own.

What was known, and what wasn't. Known: her five systems, the two that quietly compete for the same hour, and the two-week cadence they already share because it is how often she cuts his hair. Not known: whether she wants a framework at all; whether nursing-before-salon fits her real constraints or only the ones visible from a barber's chair; whether anything on a screen survives contact with two toddlers.

The options. Give her the written guide as it stands — which is addressed *to him, about her*. Rewrite it addressed to her, still static. Or make it something she moves through on a phone that ends in **one thing to do before the next haircut**.

The choice. The third, on a tablet and a phone. Delivered by hand.

What it cost and what it opened. Cost: the rework sat unbuilt for weeks after he asked for it — the delivery date is what finally produced it, which is its own lesson about what actually moves work. Opened: **the middle row of his own scale table stops being theoretical**. $n = 1$ backward is the Atlas; $n = \text{many}$ is the university; **$n = 1$ forward is her, standing at the fork now** — and until tonight that row had no instance. It has one.

The breadcrumb. *Hand the questions, not the plan.* A plan breaks the first month it meets someone's actual life. Five questions she answers herself do not, because she can answer them again when things change. The transferable thing was never the sequence — it was authorship.

Real-life sequence — the buckets (pinned 2026-09-05)

0 · Foundation — spans every bucket. Christ, my almighty LORD; I honor Him. **Richard Allred — my bedrock** (the one name the foundation writes). Purpose: help those who don't know how to help themselves. The one behind the work — unwritten, unspoken. The people who made the flywheel of my mind.

1 · Origins. Three books: Cousteau's marine biology · *A Country Printer* · *Clan of the Cave Bear*. (2026-09-19: *A Country*

Printer is Elisha Warner's — publisher of The Spanish Fork Press, Utah; first printed 1962. A softbound copy reached his grandmother, Evelyn Warner, 93, since deceased. The origin shore has a surname now. Elisha is Evelyn's father — his great-grandfather. The origin shore is a country printer's own press, in Spanish Fork. And the Cousteau book was a Santa gift, opened Christmas morning at his grandparents' — Ray and Evelyn Loveless. Both books on the shore came through that house.)

2 • Police Commander — Murray City, 1997-2017. FTO → RTO (the Daily Observation Report: OAI, by hand). The Priority of Life. 16-person tactical team; 11-person investigative division. Three people alive — citizens, officers, subjects. Shirley Sharp — homicide. **2013 — the turn:** enrolled at SLCC the next morning, still serving. The stranger's broken pinky, a week before retirement.

3 • The rebuild — 2013-2018. SLCC → UVU, BS Biology Education (2018); state teaching license. **Teacher, Alpine School District, 2018:** the Alka-Seltzer rocket lab — height by proxy, honest error bars; the girl predicted to graduate on a two-sentence paragraph — a score that lies is worse than no score.

4 • Engineer — Acima, 2019-2021. Google, my doctorate. B2B origination platform, 10,000+ daily users. Finance integration; automated adjustment. Katrina — Accounting; Brad — AR/AP. Internal audit (Dodd-Frank); external audit (SOX). Canada — actuary (goal-seek), GST/PST/HST. MC — sensei and mentor; JC — SVP, co-keystone (the canoe from the garage). **The leasability engine, with Eric:** Amazon before anyone said the name; the hammock on a 1.5-mile walk; ~\$2M year one; dismissed by everyone at first, JC included — then encouraged, never sponsored. **The acquisition:** AcceptanceNow → Acima → Upbound. How I really became a PM (2021) — *story still to be told.*

5 • Product Manager — Acima / Upbound, 2021-2024. The generative-AI assessment tool — scored so a human could decide. 16-person team, servicing overhaul. Accounting methodology to SOX across 100,000+ daily transactions.

6 • Author — WGU, Oct 2024 →. Handed the assignment: double coverage, 5→10%. Authored OAI: Genesys transcript → score & probability of good → sequences, never evaluates; ServiceNow workflow; in-house models, no new data crossings; trust contract at launch; calibration 60→80%+; 5.5 minutes out of 11; 5%→100% at flat headcount; ~\$660K (~1.5 FTE) avoided; the QA team's ~\$37M napkin — Scott (OAI), KB, NR, JR, Richard. ~4,000 synthetic decision nodes. Capacity-recovery diagnostic across Banner upgrade windows. **Mentors — LIVE,** exec champion, multiple sponsors. **Career Accelerators — sea trial:** MS in San Jose; Banner linked, kept separate; NB (Data), DK, TD (Talent Development), Security. All hands. ZP — mentor. MH — my Matthew. SP and the Provost asking for the PA-rubric trust contract, done right. **As a student:** MBA IT Management; the C213 mastery system — the framework extended to assessment. Atlas Entry 001 — KM's Nursing State (Sept 2026). **2026-09-04:** my daughter's excellence award — conflicted about AI, as was I. **Sept 2026:** the Principal AI PM interview — prompt engineering for the hiring manager.

7 • Forward. The PA-rubric trust contract. The Atlas grows; the Encyclopedia of God begins. The one ahead — unwritten. Candidates awaiting a bucket: skills · fractional roles · pharmacy & rural accessibility · optometry.

Unplaced — awaiting one word each. People: Chris Jones · Bonnei · TINA · Alba · Christy · Ben · Polish Simon · Troy · Breck · Jarome Becar · Rufus Wainwright. Anchors: Lego AT-AT · AG · Mike Rowe · Azure · RTO (meaning).

The engine (method)

- **guided-mastery** — the proto-main. The domain-agnostic framework underneath everything: diagnose from real evidence → prioritize by *leverage* → breadcrumb the first step → scaffold with immediate-feedback practice and learner-authored hooks → cut camouflage → transfer-test → build confidence honestly. Saved as an installable skill.
- **course-mastery-coach** — a specialization of the above, aimed at competency-based exam prep from assessment data. Saved as a skill.
- Structure metaphor: **git** — proto-main = the Atlas; each place/persona = a branch; each visit or step = a commit; each stamp = a tag/merge. Natural **Obsidian / Zettelkasten** home: atomic, linked place- and persona-notes with backlinks.

The node template (replaces the traveler's-guide template)

One node, six lines. Written from the far side, in the words that were available at the time.

Line	What goes in it
The node	The fork, one sentence. Where the path split.
What was known — and what wasn't	The information actually in hand at the time. This is the line that makes the trail honest and the only one that can't be written later without lying.
The options	Every branch that was really open, including the ones not taken, stated fairly enough that someone could still choose them.
The choice	Which branch, and the reasoning as it actually ran — not the reasoning that looks best now.
Cost / opened	What it closed, and what it made possible. Both, always.
The breadcrumb	The one line handed to someone standing at this node right now.
<i>Superseded (2026-09-07, kept for provenance):</i> Traveler's Résumé · Map · Itinerary · Budget · Packing & Companions · Storms · Postcards · Stamp.	

Entries / branches

#	Entry	Type	Status	File
001	Nursing State (for Kristin)	Metaphorical — a person's becoming	☐ Complete as a traveler's guide · rework to choose-your-own-adventure requested 2026-09-07, not yet written	Nursing_State_Travelers_Guide.docx / .pdf
002	The three-state swing	Literal — framed through the metaphor	Planned (next)	—

Literal atlas — the standing goals

- **All 50 U.S. states** — ~27 done, soon ~30 with a three-state swing.
- **Every unit in the National Park System** — a Passport stamp for each.
- **Ultimate destinations:** Iceland; Virgin Gorda.

Metaphorical atlas — the states of becoming

- The personas of self, each with their own destinations (career, craft, family, venture). Nursing State was Kristin's; mine are their own — to be charted as branches.

Method assets produced

- guided-mastery skill (proto-main) · course-mastery-coach skill (specialization)
- Guided_Mastery_Case_Study.docx / .pdf — one-page product case study (for the Principal AI PM interview)
- The C213 study suite (focus/mastery guides, drills, quizzes, calculator playbook) — the branch where the method was forged. See [PROJECT_LOG.md](#) for the full build history.

Milestones

- 2026-09-05 — Atlas named and logged; guided-mastery recorded as the proto-main; case study drafted; Entry 001 (Nursing State) complete.

Open threads

- Entry 002: the three-state swing (literal, metaphorical framing).
- Mock-interview drill for the Principal AI PM interview (queued).
- Stand up the Obsidian vault when ready (atomic linked entries).

© 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist. All rights reserved. Zone P work — personal identity (el.3079@gmail.com), never the institutional one. Provenance: human-authored selection, arrangement, and expression by Erik Lindquist; portions drafted with AI assistance under his direction and disclaimed as AI-generated where not materially rewritten.

Node · 2026-09-11 · Two roots on wheels, closed

The node. Pled guilty to DUI, 2026. Stated against the capital ladder when the rideshare rung came up.

What was known and what wasn't. Known: the plea and the year. Not known tonight: the conviction date, current licence status, whether a CDL was held or pursued.

The options. Leave both roots stale by design and let them sit · close them with a date · drop them from the vault.

The choice. Closed with a reopen date. Rideshare: seven-year bar on both platforms and in Utah statute (*from general knowledge, not re-checked*) — **2033**, exact date his. Semi: one-year federal CDL disqualification (*49 CFR 383.51, same caveat*), but carriers and insurers underwrite against five to ten clean years — the same horizon in practice.

Cost and opening. Cost: two roots and every dollar of the \$25k ladder that pointed at wheels. Opening: the ladder is simpler — three roots that need no capital and one reversible position. **Updated 2026-09-19, his instruction:** the opening has a shape now — *robotaxi at every bar and club in each state at closing time*. The moment the last ten yards failed becomes the first use case. He cannot drive it until 2033; he can own it now. The scar is the origin story of the instinct.

The breadcrumb. 50_Ribbon/03_Tesla_Rideshare and 04_Tesla_Semi carry the status and a pointer here; Ouroboros #216 the same. **This is the only place the fact is written.**